

SAGABOX · MARKETING ANALYTICS

# Where the ad money should go — by book, genre & country

Acquisition economics meet reading demand: CAC, activation, conversion and LTV across the catalogue and the markets that buy it.

Acquisition cohort 2026-03-06 – 2026-05-20 · current demand from the last 30 days

# Volume, engagement and monetization by genre

Acquisition cohort 2026-03-06 – 2026-05-20.

| Genre        | Readers | Share | Avg chapters | Convert | ARPPU (USD) |
|--------------|---------|-------|--------------|---------|-------------|
| Dark Romance | 119,776 | 52%   | 8.9          | 3.85%   | \$21.8      |
| Paranormal   | 68,935  | 30%   | 9.8          | 4.39%   | \$12.9      |
| Romance      | 43,175  | 19%   | 12.3         | 4.82%   | \$17.5      |

Reader volume



Conversion to paying



# Conversion to paying, by genre and market

% of readers who become paying customers. Cohort 2026-03-06 – 2026-05-20.

| Market         | Dark Romance |       | Romance | Paranormal |
|----------------|--------------|-------|---------|------------|
| United States  | 4.31%        |       | 5.29%   | 4.66%      |
| Australia      | 3.72%        | 5.03% |         | 4.84%      |
| United Kingdom | 3.97%        | 4.12% | 3.60%   |            |
| Canada         | 3.03%        | 3.77% |         | 3.52%      |
| New Zealand    | 2.76%        | 3.88% |         | 3.23%      |
| Singapore      | 3.78%        | —     | 3.37%   |            |
| Romania        | 3.62%        | 4.00% | —       |            |
| Ireland        | 3.03%        | 3.57% | —       |            |

Strong (≥5.5%)  Solid (4–5.5%)  Average (3–4%)  Weak (<3%)

# Which markets convert cheapest — CAC & activation

Cohort 2026-03-06 – 2026-05-20. Markets with ≥150 trial starts. Lower CAC and higher activation are better.

| Market         | Spend     | Trial starts | CAC    | Activation (trial→sub) | ARPPU  | ROAS |
|----------------|-----------|--------------|--------|------------------------|--------|------|
| Singapore      | \$6,465   | 162          | \$39.9 | 27.8%                  | \$13.5 | 0.34 |
| United States  | \$241,143 | 6,006        | \$40.2 | 40.4%                  | \$18.4 | 0.46 |
| Romania        | \$7,212   | 178          | \$40.5 | 18.5%                  | \$8.8  | 0.22 |
| Canada         | \$27,999  | 636          | \$44.0 | 40.6%                  | \$18.9 | 0.43 |
| Australia      | \$55,780  | 1,247        | \$44.7 | 42.5%                  | \$20.2 | 0.45 |
| United Kingdom | \$51,668  | 1,143        | \$45.2 | 33.8%                  | \$15.9 | 0.35 |
| New Zealand    | \$17,564  | 356          | \$49.3 | 36.0%                  | \$16.6 | 0.34 |

Best Strong Average Weak

CAC: green = cheap · Activation: green = high

Lowest CAC (cost per trial start)



Best activation (trial → subscription)



# How each book performs — CAC and trial→sub by country

Cohort 2026-03-06 – 2026-05-20. CAC from real spend. Best/worst country shown where the book has 100+ subscriptions.

| Book                                  | Readers | Conv. | ARPPU  | Avg CAC       | Activation | Best CAC | Best activation | Worst CAC |
|---------------------------------------|---------|-------|--------|---------------|------------|----------|-----------------|-----------|
| <b>Debt of Blood</b><br>Dark Romance  | 117,164 | 3.8%  | \$21.5 | \$42.2        | 43%        | US \$40  | <b>AU 47%</b>   | NZ \$52   |
| <b>My Demon Husband</b><br>Paranormal | 55,164  | 4.2%  | \$12.3 | <b>\$38.7</b> | 35%        | US \$38  | <b>CA 45%</b>   | GB \$45   |
| <b>She Took My Place</b><br>Romance   | 43,175  | 4.8%  | \$17.5 | <b>\$40.2</b> | 38%        | US \$38  | <b>NZ 41%</b>   | NZ \$48   |
| <b>Bad Blood</b><br>Paranormal        | 6,883   | 6.1%  | \$16.3 | <b>\$49.3</b> | 35%        | US \$48  | <b>US 36%</b>   | US only   |

Conv. = paying subs ÷ readers · ARPPU = USD revenue per payer · Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Country picks require ≥100 subs.

# Match the title to the job

Conversion from 2026-03-06–2026-05-20 cohort; current demand from last 30 days.

|                                                                                        |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>My Demon Husband</div><div>Paranormal</div></div>                            | <div>HERO</div>      | <div>#1 most-read book right now — converts and retains.</div>                                                                                                                              | <div>62.5K</div> <div>US-incl readers / 30d · 4.3% conv</div> |
| <div><div>Debt of Blood</div><div>Dark Romance</div></div>                             | <div>REACH</div>     | <div>The acquisition workhorse — broadest reader reach across markets.</div>                                                                                                                | <div>117K</div> <div>cohort readers · 3.8% conv</div>         |
| <div><div>Bad Blood</div><div>Paranormal</div></div>                                   | <div>CONVERTER</div> | <div>High reader→paying conversion — the monetization engine for retargeting.</div>                                                                                                         | <div>6.1%</div> <div>conv · ARPPU \$16</div>                  |
| <div><div>She Took My Place</div><div>Romance</div></div>                              | <div>CONVERTER</div> | <div>High reader→paying conversion — the monetization engine for retargeting.</div>                                                                                                         | <div>4.8%</div> <div>conv · ARPPU \$18</div>                  |
| <div><div>Rising titles to test</div><div>Paranormal / Romance / Romantasy</div></div> | <div>TEST</div>      | <div>High current demand, conversion still maturing: His Rejected Luna, Her Hidden Heirs, The Crescent Knew Me First, They Hated Me Until the Alpha King Knelt, The Wife He Replaced.</div> | <div>NEW</div> <div>top reads, last 30d</div>                 |

# Debt of Blood

Dark Romance · best & worst markets by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (16 qualify).

✔ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| Italy         | 50%        | \$28 | 30    |
| Sweden        | 50%        | \$57 | 26    |
| Australia     | 47%        | \$46 | 563   |
| United States | 46%        | \$40 | 2,383 |
| Canada        | 40%        | \$44 | 267   |

⚠ Worst markets

| Country     | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|-------------|------------|------|------|
| Romania     | 20%        | \$42 | 80   |
| France      | 26%        | \$31 | 31   |
| Singapore   | 28%        | \$41 | 94   |
| Netherlands | 29%        | \$53 | 38   |
| Croatia     | 33%        | \$39 | 30   |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.



# My Demon Husband

Paranormal · best & worst markets by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (8 qualify).

✅ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| Canada        | 45%        | \$38 | 146   |
| Germany       | 39%        | \$37 | 28    |
| United States | 35%        | \$38 | 1,626 |
| Australia     | 34%        | \$40 | 218   |

⚠️ Worst markets

| Country        | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|----------------|------------|------|------|
| New Zealand    | 25%        | \$43 | 51   |
| Netherlands    | 30%        | \$43 | 27   |
| United Kingdom | 31%        | \$45 | 207  |
| Singapore      | 32%        | \$27 | 34   |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.



# She Took My Place

Romance · best & worst markets by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (8 qualify).

✅ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| New Zealand   | 41%        | \$48 | 117   |
| Australia     | 41%        | \$41 | 298   |
| Canada        | 40%        | \$40 | 140   |
| United States | 40%        | \$38 | 1,226 |

⚠️ Worst markets

| Country        | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|----------------|------------|------|------|
| Germany        | 8%         | \$36 | 25   |
| Ireland        | 16%        | \$44 | 31   |
| Romania        | 20%        | \$40 | 41   |
| United Kingdom | 29%        | \$46 | 202  |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.

# Dark Romance

Best & worst markets for Dark Romance by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (16 qualify).

✔ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| Italy         | 50%        | \$28 | 30    |
| Sweden        | 50%        | \$57 | 26    |
| Australia     | 48%        | \$47 | 598   |
| United States | 46%        | \$41 | 2,482 |
| Canada        | 40%        | \$44 | 267   |

⚠ Worst markets

| Country     | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|-------------|------------|------|------|
| Romania     | 20%        | \$42 | 80   |
| France      | 26%        | \$31 | 31   |
| Singapore   | 28%        | \$41 | 94   |
| Netherlands | 29%        | \$53 | 38   |
| Croatia     | 33%        | \$39 | 30   |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.

# Paranormal

Best & worst markets for Paranormal by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (8 qualify).

✅ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| Canada        | 44%        | \$41 | 176   |
| Germany       | 39%        | \$37 | 28    |
| Australia     | 34%        | \$42 | 267   |
| United States | 34%        | \$41 | 2,192 |

⚠️ Worst markets

| Country        | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|----------------|------------|------|------|
| New Zealand    | 25%        | \$43 | 51   |
| United Kingdom | 29%        | \$46 | 252  |
| Netherlands    | 30%        | \$43 | 27   |
| Singapore      | 32%        | \$27 | 34   |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.

# Romance

Best & worst markets for Romance by trial→sub activation (CAC shown). Markets with ≥25 subscriptions (8 qualify).

✔ Best markets

| Country       | Activation | CAC  | Subs  |
|---------------|------------|------|-------|
| New Zealand   | 41%        | \$48 | 117   |
| Australia     | 41%        | \$41 | 298   |
| Canada        | 40%        | \$40 | 140   |
| United States | 40%        | \$38 | 1,226 |

⚠ Worst markets

| Country        | Activation | CAC  | Subs |
|----------------|------------|------|------|
| Germany        | 8%         | \$36 | 25   |
| Ireland        | 16%        | \$44 | 31   |
| Romania        | 20%        | \$40 | 41   |
| United Kingdom | 29%        | \$46 | 202  |

Activation = active subs ÷ trial starts. Ranked by activation; CAC shown for the cost trade-off. Low-volume markets (<25 subs) excluded.

# What to do with this

-  **Scale the proven core.** **Dark Romance** drives the most readers (120K) and the highest ARPPU (\$22); **Romance** converts best (4.8%). Lead with these.
-  **Best markets:** **Australia** activates highest (43% trial→sub); **Singapore** is cheapest to acquire (CAC \$40). Push hardest on US / AU / CA — low CAC *and* high activation.
-  **Cheap-but-don't-convert trap:** **Romania** acquires trials at CAC \$41 but only **19%** activate (ROAS 0.22). Cap spend until the funnel improves.
-  **Match title to job:** **My Demon Husband** is the current hero (62.5K readers/30d); Debt of Blood = reach, She Took My Place / Bad Blood = conversion. Hold a small budget for rising titles still maturing.